Uma Dhamija

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SERVICE DESIGNER linkedin.com/in/umadhamija · umadhamija.com

SUMMARY

Service designer and mixed-methods researcher with 5+ years improving healthcare and wellness experiences for patients, caregivers, and clinicians. I plan and run discovery research, journey mapping, and co-design workshops, and turn findings into service blueprints, ecosystem maps, and recommendations that leaders act on.

EXPERIENCE

Care2Care UX Researcher & Service Designer — Jan 2026 – Present
University of Pittsburgh & UPMC Magee-Womens Hospital · support app for caregivers of gynecologic oncology patients · team of 3

- Designed a caregiver support service, a mobile app and companion liaison web app, from research to tested prototype in **3 months**, then **won funding to build it with UPMC** (Lucie Young Kelly Faculty Leadership Award)
- Built current and future-state service blueprints and an ecosystem map, and mapped patient and caregiver journeys across the hospital, the liaison, and home
- Interviewed patients, caregivers, nurses, and frontline staff and shadowed the Family CARE Center, reframing the problem from hospital visits to caregivers' moments of uncertainty
- Designed the three-tier flagging system that routes caregivers to a live liaison, and AI matching that tailors support to each caregiver's needs from onboarding

OpenMined UX Researcher & Product Designer, MHCI Capstone — Jan 2026 – Aug 2026
AI privacy & data-security nonprofit

- Planned and ran 65 patient, clinician, and SME interviews, 50 speed-dating intercepts, and co-design workshops with 11 participants
- Led UX research and design for Kindred, a privacy-preserving peer-support platform for chronic-condition patients, designing trust into the patient and clinician experience: verified peer matching, granular health-data consent controls, and a clinician-facing trust layer
- Narrowed 36 use cases to one concept, the "Informed Patient," via a weighted framework; in concept testing, patients rated likelihood to use **8/10** and clinicians **8.5/10**
- Presented the roadmap to the CEO and Principal Engineer, who carried it forward with AI Search and Community QA

Hydrific (LIXIL) Lead UX Designer — Mar 2024 – Jun 2025
IoT smart-home hardware startup

- Led product design through a successful launch: **$114K+ raised on Kickstarter** (2024) and **15,000+ users** at retail today
- Owned UX and interaction design for core flows (onboarding, multi-home management, usage analytics); led two designers
- Pitched UX strategy to executives and investors across three company reorganizations
- Awards: **CES 2025 Innovation Awards Honoree**, **Grand One 2025 Gold** (Best UX Design), **Outstanding Achievement Award**

Hydrific (LIXIL) Senior Specialist – UX Designer — Apr 2022 – Mar 2024

- Redesigned the end-to-end installation experience across app, Bluetooth/WiFi pairing, and account sign-in through ~30 interviews and 100+ usability tests, **cutting install time by 20 min**

MeditationWise Co-Founder & Product Designer — Jun 2021 – Present
Meditation & wellness app startup

- Co-founded MeditationWise and led the pivot from web-only to mobile, targeting a younger audience to grow the user base
- Designed core flows and the design system, partnering with engineering to ship to the App Store and Google Play
- Ran usability testing and 30+ qualitative user interviews to refine onboarding, navigation, and interface flows

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University Master of Human-Computer Interaction — Sep 2025 – Aug 2026
Northwestern University MS, Information Design & Strategy — Sep 2024 – Aug 2025
New York University BS, Integrated Digital Media, Minor in Psychology — Sep 2018 – Jul 2021

SKILLS

Service Design Service Blueprinting, Ecosystem Mapping, Journey Mapping, Process Flows, Experience Strategy, Workshop Facilitation, Stakeholder Presentations

Research Discovery Research, Stakeholder Interviews, Contextual Inquiry, Observation and Shadowing, Co-Design, Usability Testing, Concept & A/B Testing, Synthesis

Design Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Prototyping, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG)

AI Tools Claude, Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, Prompt Engineering, LLM Prototyping, HTML/CSS, JavaScript

Design & Research Tools Microsoft Office, Excel, Visio, Figma, FigJam, Miro, Dovetail, Notion, Jira, Maze, UserTesting